



THE BALDWIN E-BEAT

www.baldwinschools.org

Fall 2015

Baldwin Schools Open to a New Year of Innovative Learning

Baldwin students were back to school on September 2 to a school year filled with renewed creativity and innovation in learning. The district-wide theme this year is "Excellence and Equity in Education," and all administrators have read the book *An Ethic of Excellence* by Ron Berger. There will also be continued professional development for teachers and workshops for parents to assist with the Common Core Standards.

At Baldwin High School, there are a variety of college-credit courses being offered, such as Public Affairs through Syracuse University, and a state-of-the-art TV studio that will serve as the foundation of a "New Media" Career Academy to launch in fall 2016. There is also a Bridge program at the high school to support ninth graders who struggled in middle school through an engaging academic sequence that will accelerate their success.

At Baldwin Middle School, eighth grade students have the opportunity to participate in a Pre-Academy program with an array of enrichment activities, such as Robotics and Public Speaking, that will introduce students to the Career Academy program at the high school.

The elementary schools are focusing on visual learning with trips to the Nassau County Museum of Art, in-depth studies of animals and their habitats with field experience at the Marine Nature Center, and learning about communities and the interview process with a trip to the New School in Manhattan. More exciting opportunities and school/community partnerships are to come.

We are Innovative. We are Inclusive. We are Involved.
We are Baldwin!



Welcome to Our New E-Edition of *The Baldwin Beat*!

This is a new e-edition of *The Baldwin Beat*, which will supplement printed issues during the school year in order to lower publishing costs, continue our commitment to “Going Green,” and move to a more digital mindset with the new, interactive website and mobile app. Please subscribe to the Public Information section of the district website to receive an email when a new issue of *The Baldwin Beat* has been posted there.

Assistant Superintendent for Business and Admin. Services



Dr. Stephen Draper has been appointed Assistant Superintendent for Business and Administrative Services, replacing Ed Cullen, who retired. Dr. Draper previously worked as the Assistant Superintendent for Business in the North Merrick School District. He was also a high school math teacher in the New York City schools and worked in the financial private sector. Dr. Draper has a B.A. from Skidmore College, M.A. from Columbia University, and an Ed.D. from St. John's University, where he is also an adjunct professor. Says Dr. Draper, “I look forward to working with a first-rate administrative team and gaining a fuller understanding of the fiscal and educational issues facing Baldwin.”

Director of Pupil Services



Dr. Edward Murphy was appointed Director of Pupil Services late last year after serving as interim. Dr. Murphy was previously the Secondary Supervisor for Special Education, the middle school coordinator for special education, and a school psychologist. He started in Baldwin as a psychologist intern in 2002. Dr. Murphy states, “I am looking to expand inclusive opportunities for special education students and to create a K-12 pupil services department with a programmatic continuum.”

Assistant Superintendent for Human Resources



Michelle Gallo was appointed Assistant Superintendent for Human Resources last spring after serving as interim for the first part of the year. Ms. Gallo was previously the Director of Pupil Services for nine years and Assistant Director of Pupil Services for three years. Says Ms. Gallo, “As Assistant Superintendent for Human Resources, I plan to work collaboratively with staff, students, parents and administrators to ensure that the students in Baldwin continue to receive the best education possible to prepare them to achieve their post high school goals.”

Secondary Coordinator for Special Education



Dr. Barbara Brown has been appointed Secondary Coordinator for Special Education. Dr. Brown has had a career in special education as a K-12 teacher and administrator in the Poughkeepsie, Carmel, Southampton, and Lindenhurst schools. She has a B.S. and M.S. from Marist College and an Ed.D. from Dowling College. Says Dr. Brown, “I look forward to helping our students thrive, succeed and reach their potential in a learning environment that supports individual strengths and affinities.”

Director of Fine and Performing Arts



Andre Poprilo has been appointed Director of Fine and Performing Arts, which returns the position to K-12 arts oversight. Mr. Poprilo was previously the District Coordinator of Fine Arts, Performing Arts and Foreign Language for the Wappingers Central School District, and assistant principal and District Coordinator of Fine and Technical Arts for Copiague schools. He has a M.S. from Touro College and a M.M. and B.M. from the Crane School of Music at SUNY Potsdam. Says Mr. Poprilo, "I look forward to working in Baldwin where there is such a strong reputation of student artistic achievement and community support for the arts."

Director of Literacy, Assessments, Grants and Special Projects



Michelle Peterson has been appointed Director of Literacy, Assessment, Grants and Special Projects, which refocuses the former position of Director of Curriculum to better meet the needs of the district. She has been an Assistant Principal and Director of Reading and English Language Arts for the Westbury School District, English Chairperson in Levittown, and English teacher in Huntington and Greenlawn. Ms. Peterson has a B.A. from SUNY Albany and M.S. from Hofstra University. Additionally, she is an active member of the New York State English Council, for which she will be Conference Chairperson for 2016. Says Ms. Peterson, "I look forward to working with the faculty and administrative team to ensure that we continue to do what's best for our students and use my expertise to enhance the great programs in Baldwin."

Director of Foreign Languages and English as a New Language (ENL)



Dr. Jimmy Kalamaras has been appointed Director of Foreign Languages/ENL in response to new state mandates for ENL. He was previously an assistant principal, instructional coach for RtI and ESL, and a science and elementary teacher in the New York City schools. Dr. Kalamaras is fluent in Spanish, Greek and Italian and has reading knowledge of French and Portuguese. He has a B.A. and M.S. from Queens College, and his doctorate from the CUNY Graduate Center. Dr. Kalamaras says, "Every student comes to us with valuable knowledge and experiences. When we tap into who they are as individuals, we can guide them along the path to excellence."

Director of Instructional Technology and Tech Community Partnerships



Darren Faccilonga has been appointed Director of Instructional Technology and Technology Community Partnerships to put an emphasis on instructional technology opportunities. Mr. Faccilonga was previously the Associate Director of Technology-Based Learning Systems at the New York Institute of Technology and formerly the Director of Technology for District 12 in the New York City Department of Education. He started his career as a fifth grade and technology teacher in the New York City Department of Education. Mr. Faccilonga has a B.S. from SUNY Stony Brook and M.S. degrees from Iona College and Fordham University. Mr. Faccilonga notes, "It is not enough to simply do 'things differently' with technology, but rather it is my mission to ensure our staff and students can actually do 'different things' with technology."

Meet Baldwin's New Teachers



Gina Antonucci
Meadow, Teaching Assistant
B.A., St. Joseph's College
M.S., Long Island University
"Success is possible for all learners."

Ms. Antonucci previously worked in the Lawrence and Freeport School Districts. She has heard so many wonderful things about Baldwin from her cousin, and she looks forward to helping Baldwin

students to succeed. Her hobbies are reading and photography.



Linda Blanc
Brookside, ESL
B.A. and M.S., Hofstra University
"Teaching is a partnership between the teacher, students and parents working as a team."

Ms. Blanc previously taught in the Harrison Central School District. She was attracted to the multigenerational, fond attachment that many family friends have for Baldwin. Her goal is to know her stu-

dent needs well and best meet them. Her interests include reading, languages, cooking, and travel.



Samantha Billig
BHS, Family & Consumer Science
B.A., Queens College
"To live a creative life, you must lose the fear of being wrong."

Ms. Billig comes from teaching at Mamaroneck High School. She said she is impressed by Baldwin's extensive family and consumer sciences program and the community. She plans to create strong relationships with her students

that help motivate them to learn. Outside of school, she likes cooking and snowboarding.



Betyne Farrell
BHS, School Psychologist
B.A., Molloy College
M.A., Adelphi University
"Create your life. Dream wide awake. Never give up. Wear your passion. JUST BE AWESOME."

Ms. Farrell was previously a school psychologist in District 75 in New York City. She praises the diversity in Baldwin and the district's philosophy of educational

growth beyond the classroom. She says that she will focus this year on building relationships with students and staff. She enjoys playing basketball, traveling, and spending quality time with family and friends.



Anthony D'Auria
BMS, Social Studies
B.A., SUNY Stony Brook
M.S., Queens College
"Teaching is not a job or a profession. It is a way of life."

Mr. D'Auria has taught in the Levittown and Uniondale School Districts and has been a Town of Hempstead lifeguard for 12 years. He is also the Regional Director of a national wiffle ball league and

an active bowler. Mr. D'Auria says he wants to make an impact on an already successful school district by maintaining a 100% passing rate for all his students and providing a unique insight to history.



Marykate Hill
BMS, ESL
B.S., SUNY Cortland
M.A., Touro College
"Great teachers will encourage you, listen to you, and engage you, but, most importantly, tell you how much they believe in you."

Ms. Hill has taught in private and public schools in New York City. She has several friends who grew up in Baldwin who spoke highly

of their teachers and coaches. She hopes to create engaging and exciting lessons that encourage her students to achieve. She likes playing basketball and going to the beach.

Meet Baldwin's New Teachers



Bonnie Korytny
Meadow/Plaza, Teaching Assistant

B.A., SUNY New Paltz
M.S., Hofstra University
"Teachers who love teaching teach children to love learning."

Ms. Korytny was previously a leave replacement and substitute teacher in New York City. Her goal is to help any child, regardless of ability, to learn to his or her potential. Her hobbies include reading and being part of a book club, travel, and spending time with family and friends.



Victoria Mahon
Plaza, ESL

B.A., Cornell University
M.S., Queens College
"A teacher needs to really know his or her students in order to support their success."

Ms. Mahon has previous experience in the Herricks School District as well as managerial positions in the private sector. She is proud of the cultural diversity and the striving for excellence in Baldwin and hopes to be part of a collaborative classroom filled with respect and kindness. She has been a scout leader and enjoys sewing, reading, drawing, and time with family.



Eva Mastrantuono
BHS, Science

B.A., SUNY Oneonta
M.A., Touro College
"Only compete with yourself. Always strive for your absolute best."

Ms. Mastrantuono has been teaching for two and a half years. She is a lifelong resident of Baldwin and loves the community. Her goal is for all her students to enjoy chemistry and feel confident and prepared for the Regents. Her interests include snowboarding and volunteering at an animal shelter.



Jaclyn McCaffrey
Meadow, ESL

B.A., SUNY Cortland
M.A., Touro College
"Tell me and I forget. Show me and I remember. Involve me and I learn."

Ms. McCaffrey has spent the last two years teaching ENL in the Amityville School District. Over the years, she has heard wonderful things about the Baldwin community and says the family atmosphere makes her feel at home. She hopes to enhance students' love for knowledge and language through fun and educational activities. Her hobbies are a love of reading, traveling, and spending time with family.



Andrea McCann
Meadow, Special Education

B.S., New York University
M.S., Alfred University
"If you water your students every day with belief and faith, you will end up with an amazing garden."

Ms. McCann has eight years of teaching experience. She is happy to be part of a pro-education community made up of many cultural backgrounds. She plans to help her students realize their full potential. Outside of school, she enjoys reading, yoga, creating art, and going to seeing shows.



Lisa Meyer
Meadow, Special Education

B.A., St. Joseph's College
M.S., LIU Brentwood
"Teaching is not just head to head...It is heart to heart."

Ms. Meyer was previously a kindergarten special education teacher. She was attracted to Baldwin's enthusiastic and dedicated administration and staff. Her goal is to develop and challenge herself professionally and provide her students with a "hands-on, minds-on" learning experience. Her hobbies are playing piano, cooking, reading, and spending time with family.

Meet Baldwin's New Teachers



Nicholas Pontolillo

BMS, English

B.A. Molloy College

"Establishing respect, an open-door policy, and providing meaningful learning activities are the keys to student success."

Mr. Pontolillo has prior teaching experience in the Mineola School District. He cites Baldwin's excellent reputation and looks forward to honing his teaching skills here.

His first priority is to provide an enjoyable learning experience for students and incorporate history and the fine arts in the classroom. His interests include film and music, collecting autographs, and raising money for charities.



Emily Rogers

BHS, ESL

B.S., SUNY Geneseo

M.S., College of New Rochelle

"Learning is a two-way street. I will always be learning from my students."

Ms. Rogers was previously a bilingual preschool teacher and middle school teacher in New York City. She was attracted to Baldwin's multicultural community

and family atmosphere. Her goal is to form strong relationships with her students and colleagues. Outside of school, she is a lifeguard and enjoys reading, running, and sports.



Christopher Russo

BHS, Social Studies

B.A., Queens College

M.S., Molloy College

"Teaching is about helping students grow as unique individuals."

Mr. Russo has taught 6th, 7th and 8th grades in the Lynbrook School District. He likes Baldwin's strong community and family atmosphere.

He plans to work endlessly to help students reach their fullest academic potential while having an unforgettable first year in Baldwin. His hobbies are coaching baseball and working as a camp counselor.



Rina Skorupski

Plaza, Reading

B.A., St. Joseph's College

M.A., Queens College

"A great teacher will do whatever it takes to make a difference in the life of a child."

Ms. Skorupski previously worked as a special education teacher in New York City and Nassau BOCES. She likes that Baldwin is a diverse community and family-oriented

district. Her goal for this school year is to instill a lifelong passion for reading in her students. Her interests include soccer, softball, and reading.



Debora Slavin

BHS, Special Education/English

B.A./M.B.A., SUNY Binghamton

"An extraordinary teacher challenges, encourages, empowers, and inspires."

Ms. Slavin has worked 15 years in corporate Human Resources and seven years teaching in Rockville Centre and Bayside. She lived in Baldwin for many years and continues to have strong ties with

the community. She will focus on getting to know her students and their families to help them achieve both academic and personal goals. Her hobbies are reading, travel, and gardening.



Sarah Speechley

Plaza, Teaching Assistant

B.A., Bucknell University

M.S., Molloy College

"Teachers ignite students' imaginations so they have a lifelong love of learning."

Ms. Speechley has taught social studies, science and math in the Oceanside School District. Growing up nearby, she knows what a tight-knit community Baldwin is

and looks forward to finding creative ways to teach students with special needs. Outside of school, she enjoys tennis, travel, and her two dogs - a German shepherd and chihuahua.

Meet Baldwin's New Teachers



Christina Suthakar
BHS, Science
B.S. and M.S., SUNY Stony Brook
"Teachers should guide their students to success, not provide all the answers."

Ms. Suthakar has taught in the West Babylon, Roslyn and Carle Place School Districts and Westbrook Preparatory School. She finds Baldwin staff to be very knowledgeable and professional.

She plans to build strong relationships with colleagues and inspire her students to say "wow" and "I get it" every day! She enjoys hot yoga, drawing, singing, and skydiving.



Vanessa Wolf
Meadow, ESL
B.S., SUNY Cortland
M.S., Molloy College
"Be passionate about what you teach so your students will be passionate about what they are learning."

Ms. Wolf was a special education teacher in New York City and considers Baldwin's diverse population a familiar environment. She

plans to collaborate with colleagues to strengthen her teaching strategies so she can provide multiple entry points for her students. Her hobbies include bicycling and crafts.

Baldwin Board of Education Trustee



New board trustee Annie Doresca is currently the Director of Finance & Administration at a nonprofit jewelry trade association where she oversees finance, accounting, human resources, and information technology. Mrs. Doresca has over 17 years of experience in managing financial budgets and developing strategic plans with boards and executives. In addition, she has been involved with the Brookside PTA. Mrs. Doresca and her husband are proud parents of three children and the guardians of their twin niece and nephew. "It's a party of seven!," she says, adding "As a new board trustee, I look forward to working with the board and superintendent to continue to improve the educational and enrichment opportunities for Baldwin students."

Board of Education Priorities 2015-18

Each year, the Board of Education focuses on a number of specific priorities. This year, the board has set the following priorities that will, in fact, extend over a three-year period. Administrators have been helping the board create a comprehensive strategic plan for the priorities. Residents are encouraged to attend the Community Input Meeting on October 28 to further help brainstorm ideas to facilitate these priorities within a strategic plan.

1. Improve student performance while addressing differences in achievement between different demographic groups.
2. Expand the use of technology to improve communication inside and outside the school community, and on technology as an instructional tool to enhance educational outcomes.
3. Refine and expand the Career Academy program.
4. Inspire cultural awareness and sensitivity that builds character and citizenship throughout the Baldwin community.

Important Dates

October

- 23 Youth Center, MS, 7:30pm
- 24 ACT
- 24 Saturday Night Alive, HS, 7pm
- 26 PTA Meeting, MS, 7:30pm
- 27 PTA Council, DO, 7:30pm
- 28 Community Input Meeting, HS, 8pm
- 29 Districtwide Parent Workshop: Reading Strategies (G3-5), Brookside, 7:30pm

November

- 2 Winter I Sports Tryouts, MS
- 2 Parents as Research Partners, (G4-6), Baldwin Public Library, 7pm
- 3 **SCHOOLS CLOSED FOR STUDENTS** - Superintendent's Conference Day for Staff
- 5 PTA Meetings: Brookside, 7pm; Meadow 8:45am; Plaza, 7pm
- 7 SAT I & SAT II
- 7 Intramural Night, HS, 7:50pm
- 9 Parents as Research Partners (G4-6), Baldwin Public Library, 7pm

- 10 PTA Meetings: Lenox, 7pm; Steele, 7pm
- 11 **SCHOOLS CLOSED**
- 12 Fitness Jamboree (G4-5), HS, 3:30pm
- 12 Districtwide Parent Workshop: Math Strategies (G3-5), Steele, 7pm
- 13 First Marking Period Ends, HS&MS
- 14 Saturday Night Alive, HS, 7pm
- 16 Winter Sports Tryouts, HS
- 16 Science Symposium, MS, 7pm
- 17 Parent-Teacher Conferences, HS, 6:45-9:15pm
- 18 Board of Education Meeting, Steele, 8pm
- 19 Musical Production: *Anything Goes*, HS, 4pm
- 20 Musical Production: *Anything Goes*, HS, 7:30pm
- 21 Musical Production: *Anything Goes*, HS, 2 & 7:30pm
- 24 SEPTA Pie Pick up, HS, 7am-8pm
- 24 PTA Meeting, MS, 7:30pm
- 25 Report Cards, HS&MS
- 26 **SCHOOLS CLOSED**
- 27 **SCHOOLS CLOSED**
- 30 PTSA Meeting, HS, 7:30pm

Baldwin School District Launches New Website and Mobile App

If you have not already done so, check out the new district website at **www.baldwinschools.org**. The website is interactive so *sign UP* to receive e-alert text messages and subscribe to areas of the website to receive emails when those areas are updated. For instance, be sure to subscribe to the "Virtual Backpack" page for flyers and letters from your child's school. We have also piloted using the online registration feature for the Parent Academy Workshop and the Art for Charity Children's Halloween Workshop this month.

Click on the "global icons" to the right on the home page for quick links to calendars, menus, staff directory, Parent Portal, and MySchoolBucks (for online payment for testing, lunch, instrumental rentals, etc.) The entire website can be translated into various languages, and there is a drop-down

menu to "Select a School" to go to the school sites. Scroll down the home page to learn more about the district's signature programs, latest news, announcements, and upcoming dates. And wherever you are on the website, just remember to click on the Baldwin B on the top left - and it will bring you home!

In addition, the mobile app is available for free download from either the iTunes Store or Google Play, depending on your cell phone. Search "Baldwin School District" to find our mobile app. The app has curated content from the website for when you are on the go, such as school contact information, recent news, and announcements. A red band will appear on top of the cell phone screen when there is an e-alert being sent with an emergency message.



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Baldwin School District

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Baldwin Public Schools